

PHISING INVESTIGATION REPORT "A HOPE TO CoCanDa.eml"

Findings

- **Time:** Tue, 26 Jan 2021 01:41:18 -0500 (EST)
- **Recipient:** themajoronearth@gmail.com
- **Spoofed Sender:** billjobs@microapple.com
- **Reply-To Address:** negeja3921@pashter.com
- **Source IP:** 93.99.104.210 (emkei.cz)
- **Authentication Result:** SPF = Fail
- **Subject:** *A Hope to CoCanDa*
- **Attachment:** PuzzleToCoCanDa.pdf (Base64 encoded PDF attachment)

Investigation Summary

On **26 January 2021 at 01:41:18 EST**, an email was delivered to **themajoronearth@gmail.com** from the spoofed sender **billjobs@microapple.com**. The email failed SPF authentication, indicating that the sending server was not authorized to send email on behalf of the claimed domain. The message originated from **G3.GG.104.210 (emkei.cz)**, a service commonly used for sending spoofed emails. The email instructed the recipient to open a PDF attachment named **PuzzleToCoCanDa.pdf**, making this a likely phishing or social engineering attempt designed to lure the victim into interacting with the attachment. Based on the available evidence, there is no indication that the attachment was opened or that any malware was executed.

IOC Type	Indicator	Purpose
Source IP Address	93.99.104.210	Originating IP address used to send the phishing email.
Sending Service	emkei.cz	Public email spoofing service used to generate the message.
Spoofed Sender	billjobs@microapple.com	Fraudulent sender intended to impersonate a legitimate source.
Reply-To Address	negeja3921@pashter.com	Address where attacker expects victim responses.
Target Email	themajoronearth@gmail.com	Intended recipient of the phishing email.
Email Subject	A Hope to CoCanDa	Useful for identifying similar phishing emails.

IOC Type	Indicator	Purpose
Attachment	PuzzleToCoCanDa.pdf	Suspicious PDF attachment used as the phishing lure.
Attachment Type	Base64 Encoded PDF	Indicates the attachment was encoded for transmission.
Authentication Result	SPF: Fail	Indicates sender authentication failed, suggesting spoofing.
Attack Technique	Email Spoofing / Phishing	Primary attack method observed.

Who, What, When, Where, Why, How

WHO

- **Target:** themajoronearth@gmail.com
- **Claimed Sender:** billjobs@microapple.com
- **Reply-To Address:** negeja3921@pashter.com
- **Sending Host:** 93.99.104.210 (emkei.cz)

WHAT

A phishing email was received containing:

- A spoofed sender address
- Failed SPF authentication
- A suspicious Reply-To address different from the sender
- A PDF attachment (**PuzzleToCoCanDa.pdf**) intended to persuade the recipient to continue interacting with the attacker.

WHEN

- **Date:** Tuesday, 26 January 2021
- **Time:** 01:41:18 EST (UTC-5)
- Based on the available evidence, it cannot be determined whether any additional malicious activity occurred after the email was received.

WHERE

The activity occurred within the recipient's email account (**themajoronearth@gmail.com**). The email originated from **G3.GG.104.210 (emkei.cz)** rather than a legitimate mail server for the claimed sender.

WHY

The attacker appears to be conducting a **social engineering/phishing campaign** by using:

- A spoofed sender identity
- An unauthenticated email (SPF failure)
- A malicious or suspicious attachment
- A mismatched Reply-To address

The goal is likely to convince the recipient to open the attachment or continue communication with the attacker.

HOW

The attacker sent a spoofed email through **emkei.cz**, causing SPF authentication to fail. The email included a PDF attachment and attempted to manipulate the recipient using fictional ransom-style messaging and puzzle instructions. The differing Reply-To address

suggests responses would be redirected to the attacker's mailbox rather than the spoofed sender.

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	ATT&CK ID
Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment	T1566.001
Email Spoofing	T1586.002 (Infrastructure/Identity-related)
Social Engineering	T1656

Recommendations

1. **Do not open** the attached PDF unless it has been analyzed in a secure sandbox.
2. **Block or quarantine** emails originating from **G3.GG.104.210** and similar spoofing services if permitted by organizational policy.
3. **Block the Reply-To address (negeja3G21@pashter.com)** and investigate whether it appears in other phishing attempts.
4. **Search mail logs** for additional emails with the same sender, Reply-To address, subject, or source IP to identify other potential targets.
5. **Verify email authentication** (SPF, DKIM, and DMARC) and strengthen email filtering policies to reduce spoofed email delivery.
6. **Educate users** to recognize phishing indicators such as failed authentication, mismatched sender and Reply-To addresses, unexpected attachments, and suspicious requests.
7. If the attachment was opened, **perform endpoint analysis** on the affected system to determine whether any malicious payload was executed or additional compromise occurred.